Aaron M. Bornstein **Updated: October 19, 2026**

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CURRENT POSITION

2019- Assistant Professor, Department of Cognitive Sciences
Faculty, Institute for Mathematical Behavioral Sciences
Fellow, Center for the Neurobiology of Learning and Memory
University of California, Irvine

PREVIOUS APPOINTMENTS

2019-2025 Assistant Professor, Department of Cognitive Sciences, UC Irvine
2018 Associate Research Scholar, Princeton Neuroscience Institute
2013-2018 Postdoctoral Research Associate, Princeton Neuroscience Institute
2007-2013 Graduate researcher, New York University
2006 Research assistant, Deicken lab, UCSF/VA
2005-2007 Research assistant, Wagner lab, Stanford

EDUCATION

2013 Ph.D., Cognition & Perception, **New York University**
2003 S.B., Mathematics (additional concentration in Economics)
Massachusetts Institute of Technology

TEACHING/SERVICE

UC Irvine

Spring 2027 Neural Data Analysis (Undergraduate)
Fall 2026 Cognitive Maps (Graduate; cross-listed with Critical Theory Emphasis)
Fall 2025 Resisting "Neuro-narratives" (Undergraduate)
Winter 2025,2027 LIFTED UC Irvine Prison Education Program (Human Memory)
Spring 2023-2026,Winter 2027 Human Memory (Undergraduate)
Spring 2023-24,Fall 2025 Decision making (Graduate)
Spring 2021-22 Decision making & Problem solving (Graduate; with Prof. Zygmunt Pizlo)
Spring 2020 Topics in Reinforcement Learning (Graduate; with Prof. Mimi Liljeholm)
Spring 2019-22 Research in Exp Psych (Undergraduate; with Prof. Nadia Chernyak)
Winter 2019-22 Advanced Experimental Psychology (Undergraduate)

Other teaching/mentorship

Fall 2020	Neuromatch academy mentor
Summer 2020	Neuromatch academy group leader
Summer 2020	GSMI Cientifico Latino
2019	MEET alumni mentor

Summer 2018 Computational & Cognitive Neuroscience Summer School, Suzhou, China

2016-2018 Princeton Prison Teaching Initiative

Summer 2007,08 MIT Middle East Education through Technology (MEET), Jerusalem

University/Department service

2024-	UCI Research Imaging Equipment Committee
2022-2025	Cognitive Sciences Colloquium committee, faculty advisor

2021- Irvine Faculty Association, Executive board member; 2023-2025 Treasurer; 2025- Co-Chair

2020	CNLM "Evening to Remember" organizational committee
2019-	First-Generation Faculty Initiative
2019-	UCI Prison Education Program, advisory board, curriculum committee
2019,23	Cognitive Sciences faculty search committee
2018,20,22,24	Cognitive Sciences PhD admissions committee

Organizational/Field service

2025- Associate Editor, *Cognitive Science.*

2025- Justice, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee, *Memory Disorders Research Society.*

2025-	Advisor, *All People's Health Collective.*
2024-	Editorial board, *Translational Neuroscience.*

2023 UCI Conte Center annual symposium, organized with the Conte Center Team.

2022 NSF/Simons NeuroDataScience workshop, Co-Organizer (with Norbert Fortin and Babak Shahbaba)

2021 Center for Neurobiology of Learning and Memory Spring Meeting Co-organizer (with Lulu Chen)

2018 Princeton Neuroscience Institute "Inside-Out" seminar series Co-organizer (with Ahmed El Hady)

2018 "Goal-Directed Decision Making: Computations and Circuits" *Elsevier* Co-editor (with Richard Morris & Amitai Shenhav)

2015 COSYNE Workshop "Memory in action: The role(s) of the hippocampus in decisions for reward" Co-organizer (with G. Elliott Wimmer)